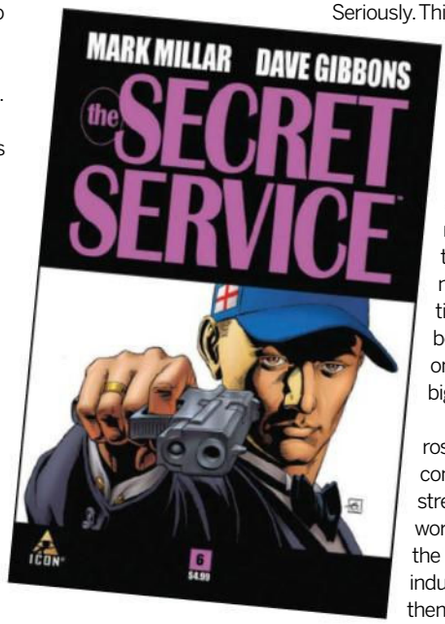
the various comics, movies and games we're doing. My Marvel years were great, but this is my job now."

Even though Millar has now separated creatively from Marvel, it wasn't due to any bad blood between the writer and the company. "I did ten years at Marvel and left around five years ago to do my own comics and movies, so I'm not in that creative brain-trust anymore. All the work I did at Marvel is work-for-hire, so they're absolutely within their rights to use *Ultimates* for *The Avengers* or *Captain America* or whatever. It's nice to see your story have another life a few years later, but it's not something I've been part of because I have my own company now. I'm friendly with Marvel and see the guys socially, but I don't work there."



Millar's work for them is still heavily influencing the cinematic worlds of the comic juggernaut, what with his work on the *Ultimates* heavily drawn upon for the main MCU storylines, working as a creative consultant with Fox on the *X-Men* and *Fantastic Four* franchises, and his acclaimed comic, *Old Man Logan* rumoured to be the basis of the upcoming *Wolverine 3*.

Of working on the title, Millar says, "Wolverine was based very much on Eastwood's *Man With No Name*, so I thought it would be fun to give him his final adventure, like Bill Munny in *Unforgiven*. It just felt like a natural conclusion." Which could lend itself well to the James Mangold-helmed sequel.

Having worked as a creative consultant with Fox on their portion of the Marvel Universe since 2012, Millar has been influential in the making of many of their recent movies. "I'm not so much a public face, as such, I just sit with the execs, like what we do is we sit and plan and say 'Is it worth spinning off this thing?' or 'Who is a good writer/director for this?' and, you know, 'Does this thing have legs?' so all my things I signed an NDA for. I literally can't talk about it. It's always so annoying because I know all the cool plans."

While he can't talk about anything owned by other people, what he can discuss is everything he owns under the Millarworld umbrella. When asked where the idea came from for the blood-soaked *Kick-Ass* stories, he says, "It's my alternate autobiography. Seriously. This is what I planned to do when I was around fourteen – but fortunately didn't." Fortunate indeed for the world of comics, as his creative mind has become the source for many inspiring titles that seem to be making their way onto the cinema's big screen.

His upcoming roster looks to continue his strong streak of titles, working with some of the best artists in the industry and adopting them into his creator-owned world, "I stole Marvel and DC's biggest artists with Stuart Immonen (*Star Wars*) and Greg Capullo (*Batman*). So I've been working on those new books and we have the *Jupiter's Legacy* sequel coming up with Frank Quitely, who is just astonishing. He may be the best in the world."

And his workload doesn't stop there, with several movie adaptations on the horizon. He expands, "We're looking at *Huck*, *Superior*, *Starlight* and *Empress* all shooting between this Autumn and next Summer. It's very exciting. *Chrononauts* and *Jupiter's Legacy* are being written at the moment too, so hopefully we'll get directors on there soon. I feel quite spoiled."

In 2015 *Kingsman: The Secret Service* shocked and entertained audiences with a violence and humour all of its own. A sequel – *The Golden Circle* – is in the works already. "Dave Gibbons and I only did one book and that was adapted into the first film, *Kingsman: The Secret Service. The Golden Circle* is like *Hellboy 2: The Golden Army* in that it's an original screenplay taking place using our characters. It's Matthew [Vaughn] and Jane [Goldman] and some of the best actors in the world. It's thus impossible to fail." And frankly, if Millar has every faith in it, so do we.

Entering Millar's World

The writer on owning his own creative freedom

Even though Millar looks back on his time at Marvel fondly, back in 2004 he set up his own comic-creating company, Millarworld. He cites one very simple and completely understandable reason: "I wanted to own my own creations." This isn't to say that he lacked creative control when he worked with Marvel, he explains, "I was very lucky and had a great relationship with them. They were always very nice and very open to what I wanted to do." But Millar wasn't content to stop there.

"I started in 2004 and we sold tons of the *Wanted* comic. The movie sold before the first issue came out, so I realised I was onto something and I could either keep working for someone else or be my own boss and share the profits ethically with the artists."

What this means is that Millar has formulated his own way of doing things, taking into account what the other comic companies perhaps turn a blind eye to. "What I do is offer the other creators the same rates they get at Marvel or DC, but give them 50 per cent of all ownership, no matter whether it's movies, games, lunch boxes – you name it and our merchandising is just getting wider and wider. It's all the advantages of creator-owned (including the producer deals I've worked up for the last 12 years), but none of the risks. Hence why I've got the best artists in the industry."

